

Documents File Plan Module Documentation

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Documents File Plan Module Documentation

Module: documents_file_plan **Version:** 18.0.1.0.0 **Author:** Nated Systems **Date:** February 6, 2026

Executive Summary

The **Documents File Plan** module is a comprehensive document management extension that bridges physical document records with Odoo's digital document system. It adds file plan categorization, tracking, and workflow capabilities for managing documents with temporal references (month/year) and organizational metadata.

Module Purpose

This module extends Odoo's document management capabilities by:

- Providing structured file plan organization by time periods (month/year)
 - Integrating physical document records with the digital document system
 - Enabling document tracking by department and physical location
 - Supporting sender/receiver workflow tracking
 - Managing unique document reference numbers (D Number, UMZ Number)
 - Facilitating document request and submission workflows
-

Key Features

1. Document Categorization

- **Temporal Organization:** Track documents by month and year (50 years back, 20 years forward)
- **Organizational Structure:** Associate documents with departments and physical locations
- **Reference Numbers:** Support for D Number and UMZ Number tracking
- **Flexible Year Range:** Dynamic year selection from 1976 to 2046

2. Sender/Receiver Tracking

- Record who sends files (defaults to current user)
- Track who receives files
- Maintain submission dates and timestamps
- Create audit trail for document transfers

3. Two-way Synchronization

- Automatic sync between Physical Record Keeper and Documents module
- Create or update document records based on physical records
- Maintain metadata consistency across systems
- Triggered automatically on create/update operations

4. Request Workflow

- Users can request files from other users
- Track requester and requestee information
- Include department and location context
- Record request dates for follow-up

5. Submission Workflow

- Structured document submission process
- Rich metadata capture (2 HTML description fields)
- Folder-based organization
- Multi-view support (list, form, kanban, activity)

6. Advanced Search and Filtering

- Filter by month, year, department, location
 - Search by D Number or UMZ Number
 - Group by folder, month, or year
 - Multi-field search capabilities
-

Technical Architecture

Module Dependencies

- **documents:** Core Odoo documents module
- **physical_document_records_manage:** Physical records management system

Models Extended

1. documents.document

New Fields: - reference_month: Selection field (January-December) - reference_year: Selection field (dynamic year range) - description_1: HTML field for detailed description - description_2: HTML field for additional description - sender_id: Many2one link to res.users (default: current user) - receiver_id: Many2one link to res.users - department_id: Many2one link to hr.department - location_id: Many2one link to custom.physical.location - d_number: Character field - umz_number: Character field - submission_date: Datetime field

2. documents.request_wizard

New Fields: - department_id: Many2one link to hr.department - location_id: Many2one link to custom.physical.location - d_number: Character field - umz_number: Character field - requester_id: Many2one link to res.users (default: current user) - request_date: Datetime field

3. physical.record.keeper.custom

New Fields: - reference_month: Selection field (required) - reference_year: Selection field (required) - attachment_id: Many2one link to ir.attachment (required) - folder_id: Many2one link to documents.document (required, folder type only)

New Methods: - _sync_document_record(): Synchronizes physical records with document records

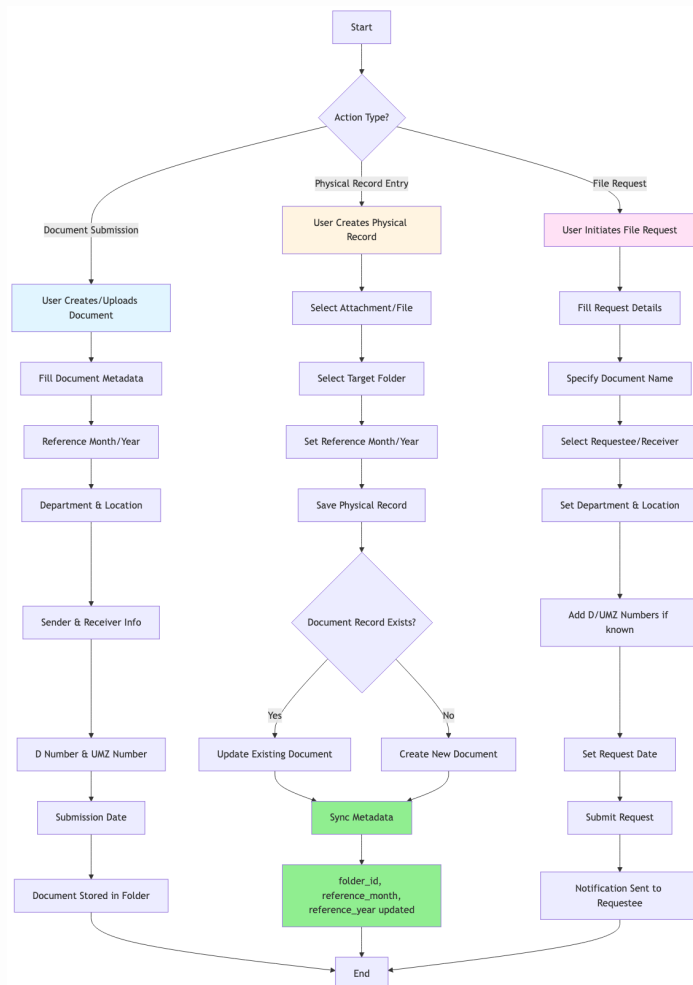
Process Workflows

Complete Process Flow Diagram

```

graph TD
    A[Start] --> B{Action Type?}
    B -->|Document Submission| C[User Creates/Uploads Document]
    B -->|Physical Record Entry| D[User Creates Physical Record]
    B -->|File Request| E[User Initiates File Request]
    C --> C1[Fill Document Metadata]
    C1 --> C2[Reference Month/Year]
    C2 --> C3[Department & Location]
    C3 --> C4[Sender & Receiver Info]
    C4 --> C5[D Number & UMZ Number]
    C5 --> C6[Submission Date]
    C6 --> C7[Document Stored in Folder]
    C7 --> Z[End]
    D --> D1[Select Attachment/File]
    D1 --> D2[Select Target Folder]
    D2 --> D3[Set Reference Month/Year]
    D3 --> D4[Save Physical Record]
    D4 --> D5{Document Record Exists?}
    D5 -->|Yes| D6[Update Existing Document]
    D5 -->|No| D7[Create New Document]
    D6 --> D8[Sync Metadata]
    D7 --> D8
    D8 --> D9[folder_id, reference_month, <br/>reference_year updated]
    D9 --> Z
    E --> E1[Fill Request Details]
    E1 --> E2[Specify Document Name]
    E2 --> E3[Select Requestee/Receiver]
    E3 --> E4[Set Department & Location]
    E4 --> E5[Add D/UMZ Numbers if known]
    E5 --> E6[Set Request Date]
    E6 --> E7[Submit Request]
    E7 --> E8[Notification Sent to Requestee]
    E8 --> Z
    style C fill:#e1f5ff
    style D fill:#fff4e1
    style E fill:#ffe1f5
    style D8 fill:#90ee90
    style D9 fill:#90ee90

```



Complete Process Flow Diagram

Workflow 1: Document Submission Process

Steps: 1. User navigates to File Submission menu 2. User creates/uploads a new document 3. System prompts for metadata: - Document name - File upload - Reference month and year - Department and location - Sender and receiver information - D Number and UMZ Number (if applicable) - Submission date - Description fields 4. Document is saved to selected folder 5. Document becomes searchable and accessible

User Interface: - Custom list view with month/year columns - Enhanced form view with all metadata fields - Kanban and activity views available - Multi-edit support for bulk operations

Workflow 2: Physical Record Synchronization

Steps: 1. User creates or updates a Physical Record 2. User selects: - Attachment/File (required) - Target Folder (required) - Reference Month (required) - Reference Year (required) 3. System triggers `_sync_document_record()` method 4. System searches for existing document with same attachment 5. **If document exists:** - System updates existing document - Updates `folder_id`, `reference_month`, `reference_year` 6. **If document doesn't exist:** - System creates new document - Populates name from attachment - Sets `attachment_id`, `folder_id`, `reference_month`, `reference_year` 7. Document is now accessible via File Submission menu

Technical Details:

```
def _sync_document_record(self):
    """Sync documents.document based on the current attachment/folder/month/year."""
    for record in self:
        if not record.attachment_id or not record.folder_id:
            continue # Skip incomplete rows

        doc = self.env['documents.document'].sudo().search([
            ('attachment_id', '=', record.attachment_id.id)
        ], limit=1)

        doc_vals = {
            'folder_id': record.folder_id.id,
            'reference_month': record.reference_month,
            'reference_year': record.reference_year,
        }

        if doc:
            doc.write(doc_vals)
        else:
            self.env['documents.document'].sudo().create({
                'name': record.attachment_id.name,
                'attachment_id': record.attachment_id.id,
                'folder_id': record.folder_id.id,
                'reference_month': record.reference_month,
                'reference_year': record.reference_year,
            })
```

Synchronization Sequence Diagram:

```
sequenceDiagram
    participant User
    participant PhysicalRecord as Physical Record Keeper
    participant SyncMethod as _sync_document_record()
    participant Document as Documents Module
    participant Attachment as Attachments

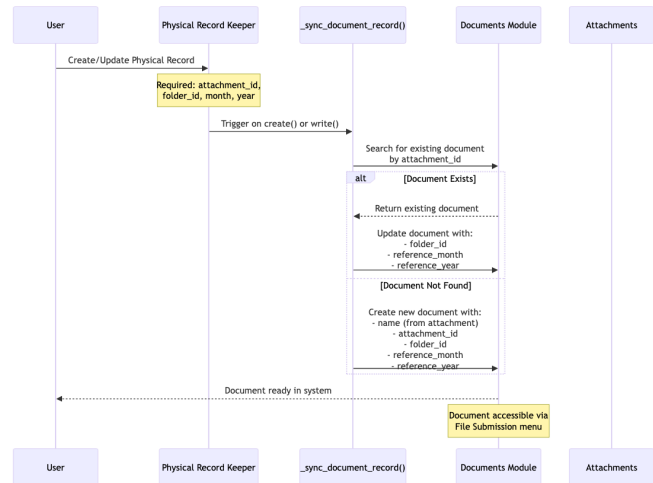
    User->>PhysicalRecord: Create/Update Physical Record
    Note over PhysicalRecord: Required: attachment_id,<br/>folder_id, month, year

    PhysicalRecord->>SyncMethod: Trigger on create() or write()

    SyncMethod->>Document: Search for existing document<br/>by attachment_id

    alt Document Exists
        Document->>SyncMethod: Return existing document
        SyncMethod->>Document: Update document with:<br/>- folder_id<br/>- reference_month<br/>- reference_year
    else Document Not Found
        SyncMethod->>Document: Create new document with:<br/>- name (from attachment)
    <br/>- attachment_id<br/>- folder_id<br/>- reference_month<br/>- reference_year
    end

    Document->>User: Document ready in system
    Note over Document: Document accessible via<br/>File Submission menu
```



Physical Record Sync Sequence Diagram

Workflow 3: File Request Process

Steps: 1. User navigates to File Request menu 2. User clicks “Create” to open request wizard 3. User fills in request details: - Document name or description - Requestee (person to request from) - Folder where document should be located - Department and location (if known) - D Number and UMZ Number (if known) - Requester (defaults to current user) - Request date 4. User clicks “Request” button 5. System creates request record 6. Notification sent to requestee 7. Request tracked for follow-up

User Interface: - List view showing all requests - Form view with request button in header - Fields for requester, requestee, department, location

Data Model

Entity Relationships

- DOCUMENTS_DOCUMENT** (Core document entity) - Contains files or references to files - Linked to folder, sender, receiver, department, location - Has temporal references (month/year) - Has unique identifiers (D/UMZ numbers)
- PHYSICAL_RECORD_KEEPER** (Physical records tracking) - Linked to attachment and folder - Has temporal references (month/year) - Automatically syncs to DOCUMENTS_DOCUMENT
- REQUEST_WIZARD** (File request tracking) - Links requester and requestee (users) - Specifies target folder, department, location - Includes reference numbers for identification

Entity Relationship Diagram

```

erDiagram
    DOCUMENTS_DOCUMENT {
        char name
        selection reference_month
        selection reference_year
        html description_1
        html description_2
        many2one sender_id
        many2one receiver_id
        many2one department_id
        many2one location_id
        char d_number
        char umz_number
        datetime submission_date
        many2one folder_id
        many2one attachment_id
    }

    PHYSICAL_RECORD_KEEPER {
        selection reference_month
        selection reference_year
        many2one attachment_id
        many2one folder_id
    }

    REQUEST_WIZARD {
        char name
        many2one department_id
        many2one location_id
        char d_number
        char umz_number
        many2one requester_id
        many2one requestee_id
        datetime request_date
        many2one folder_id
    }

    RES_USERS {
        char name
        char email
    }

    HR_DEPARTMENT {
        char name
    }

    CUSTOM_PHYSICAL_LOCATION {
        char name
    }

    IR_ATTACHMENT {
        char name
        binary datas
    }

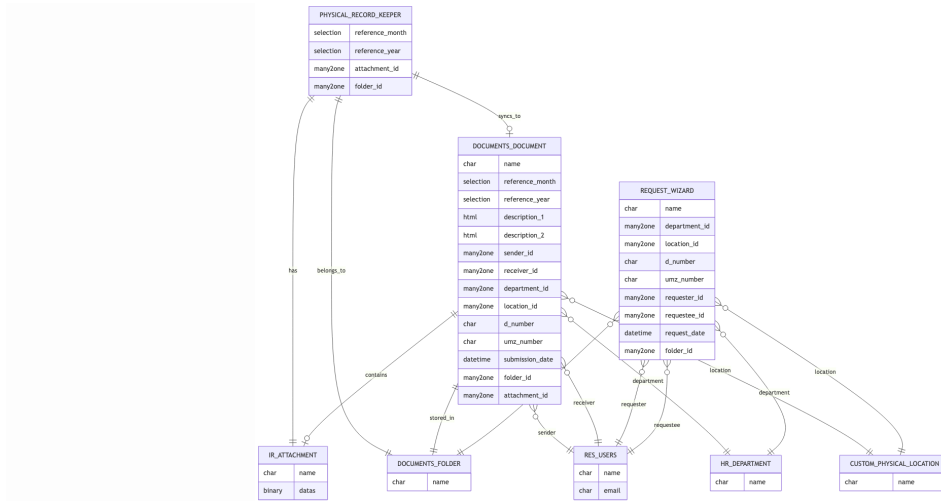
    DOCUMENTS_FOLDER {
        char name
    }

    PHYSICAL_RECORD_KEEPER ||--|| IR_ATTACHMENT : has
    PHYSICAL_RECORD_KEEPER ||--|| DOCUMENTS_FOLDER : belongs_to
    PHYSICAL_RECORD_KEEPER ||--o|| DOCUMENTS_DOCUMENT : syncs_to

    DOCUMENTS_DOCUMENT ||--o|| IR_ATTACHMENT : contains
    DOCUMENTS_DOCUMENT ||--|| DOCUMENTS_FOLDER : stored_in
    DOCUMENTS_DOCUMENT }o--|| RES_USERS : sender
    DOCUMENTS_DOCUMENT }o--|| RES_USERS : receiver
    DOCUMENTS_DOCUMENT }o--|| HR_DEPARTMENT : department
    DOCUMENTS_DOCUMENT }o--|| CUSTOM_PHYSICAL_LOCATION : location

    REQUEST_WIZARD }o--|| RES_USERS : requester
    REQUEST_WIZARD }o--|| RES_USERS : requestee
    REQUEST_WIZARD }o--|| HR_DEPARTMENT : department
    REQUEST_WIZARD }o--|| CUSTOM_PHYSICAL_LOCATION : location
    REQUEST_WIZARD }o--|| DOCUMENTS_FOLDER : target_folder

```



Module Data Model Diagram

Key Relationships

- Physical Record Keeper → Documents Document (one-to-one sync)
- Documents Document → IR Attachment (one-to-one)
- Documents Document → Documents Folder (many-to-one)
- Documents Document → Users (many-to-one for sender/receiver)
- Documents Document → HR Department (many-to-one)
- Documents Document → Physical Location (many-to-one)

User Interface Components

Menu Structure

Documents Module Menu: 1. File Submission (Sequence: 2) - Path: documents_submission - Views: List, Form, Kanban, Activity - Domain: Binary documents only - Purpose: Direct document upload and management

- 2. File Request** (Sequence: 3)
 - Views: List, Form
 - Purpose: Request files from other users

Physical Record Keeper Menu: 1. File Submission (Sequence: 13) - Linked to document submission action

- 2. File Request** (Sequence: 14)
 - Linked to request wizard action

Views

List View Enhancements

- Added reference_month column
- Added reference_year column
- Multi-edit capability
- Sorting by folder, creation date
- Display of document count

Form View Enhancements

- Two-column layout with grouped fields
- Left column: File, folder, sender, receiver, location, department, submission date
- Right column: Type, dates, creator, lock status, month, year, reference numbers
- Description fields for detailed notes
- Access/Download/Lock/Unlock buttons in header
- Chatter for communication

Search View Enhancements

- Search by file, folder, month, year
- Group by month and year filters
- Combined with existing document search capabilities

Business Use Cases

Use Case 1: Monthly Report Filing

Scenario: HR department needs to file monthly payroll reports

Steps: 1. HR manager uploads January 2026 payroll report 2. Sets reference month to "January" and year to "2026" 3. Sets department to "Human Resources" 4. Adds sender (self) and receiver information 5. Document is filed and easily retrievable by month/year

Benefits: - Organized by time period - Easy retrieval of specific month's reports - Audit trail maintained

Use Case 2: Physical File Digitization

Scenario: Records department is digitizing physical archives

Steps: 1. Clerk scans physical document to PDF 2. Creates Physical Record entry 3. Attaches scanned PDF 4. Selects target folder and month/year 5. System automatically creates Document record 6. Physical and digital records are linked

Benefits: - Seamless physical-to-digital transition - No duplicate data entry - Maintains consistency between systems

Use Case 3: Cross-Department File Request

Scenario: Legal needs a document from Finance

Steps: 1. Legal staff member opens File Request 2. Creates request specifying: - Document needed (by D Number) - Requestee: Finance Manager - Department: Finance 3. Finance Manager receives notification 4. Finance Manager uploads or shares document 5. Legal receives access to document

Benefits: - Formal request tracking - Clear accountability - Documented file transfers

Search and Filtering Capabilities

Available Filters

By Time Period: - Month (January through December) - Year (1976 - 2046) - Creation date - Submission date - Request date

By Organization: - Department - Physical location - Folder

By People: - Sender - Receiver - Requester - Requestee - Creator - Lock owner

By Identifiers: - Document name - D Number - UMZ Number - Attachment/File name

Grouping Options

- Group by folder
 - Group by month
 - Group by year
 - Group by department
 - Group by location
-

Security Considerations

Access Control

- Inherits from base documents module security
- Sender defaults to current user (prevents spoofing)
- Requester defaults to current user
- Sudo access used for sync operations (ensures consistency)

Data Integrity

- Required fields enforced on Physical Record (attachment, folder, month, year)

- Synchronization happens automatically (no manual intervention)
 - Domain restrictions ensure folders only (not files) selected as destinations
-

Configuration Requirements

Prerequisites

- Odoo Documents module installed and configured
- Physical Document Records Management module installed
- HR module (for department data)
- Users configured with proper access rights

Setup Steps

1. Install documents_file_plan module
 2. Configure document folders structure
 3. Set up physical locations (custom.physical.location)
 4. Configure departments (if not already done)
 5. Train users on file submission and request workflows
-

Technical Specifications

Year Range Function

```
@staticmethod
def year_range_selection(start_offset, end_offset, steps=1):
    current_year = fields.Datetime.now().year
    return [(str(year), str(year)) for year in range(
        current_year - start_offset,
        current_year + end_offset,
        steps
    )]
```

- Dynamic calculation based on current year
- Supports 50 years backward, 20 years forward
- Configurable step parameter (default: 1 year)

Auto-Sync Trigger Points

- Triggered on create() method of Physical Record Keeper
 - Triggered on write() method of Physical Record Keeper
 - Executes in sudo mode for reliable permissions
 - Searches by attachment_id for existing records
 - Creates or updates as needed
-

Reporting and Analytics

Available Reports

- Documents grouped by month and year
- Documents by department
- Documents by location
- Documents by sender/receiver
- Request tracking reports

Data Export

- Standard Odoo export functionality available
 - Export filtered lists to Excel/CSV
 - Include all custom fields in exports
-

Best Practices

For Document Management

1. Always specify month and year for time-sensitive documents
2. Use consistent folder structure across departments
3. Fill in D Number and UMZ Number when available

4. Provide meaningful descriptions in description fields
5. Set sender and receiver for accountability

For Physical Record Synchronization

1. Ensure attachment is uploaded before saving physical record
2. Select appropriate target folder matching document type
3. Verify month and year are correct before saving
4. Review synchronized document record for accuracy

For File Requests

1. Be specific in request name/description
 2. Include all known identifiers (D/UMZ numbers)
 3. Specify department and location to help requestee
 4. Follow up on pending requests regularly
-

Troubleshooting

Common Issues

Issue: Document not appearing after physical record creation - **Solution:** Verify attachment_id and folder_id are set - Check that record was saved successfully - Verify user has access to target folder

Issue: Cannot find document by month/year - **Solution:** Ensure month and year fields were populated - Check filter settings in search view - Verify grouping is set correctly

Issue: Request not received - **Solution:** Verify requestee user is active - Check notification settings - Ensure proper email configuration

Future Enhancements

Potential Improvements

- Automated retention policy based on month/year
 - Bulk upload with automatic month/year detection
 - Integration with external file storage systems
 - Advanced analytics dashboard
 - Mobile application support
 - Barcode/QR code generation for physical files
 - Email integration for document submission
-

Support and Maintenance

Developer: Nated Systems **Website:** <https://natedsystems.co.za> **Module Path:** /documents_file_plan/ **License:** AGPL-3

Module Files

- __init__.py: Module initialization
 - __manifest__.py: Module metadata and dependencies
 - models/documents_document.py: Document model extensions
 - models/physical_record_keeper.py: Physical record synchronization
 - views/documents_document_view.xml: Document views and actions
 - views/physical_record_keeper_view.xml: Physical record views
-

Conclusion

The Documents File Plan module provides a comprehensive solution for managing documents with temporal and organizational context. Its automatic synchronization between physical and digital records ensures data consistency, while the request workflow facilitates inter-departmental document sharing. The flexible filtering and grouping capabilities make it easy to organize and retrieve documents based on various criteria.

Key benefits include: - **Organized Structure:** Time-based and department-based organization - **Automation:** Automatic sync reduces manual work and errors - **Traceability:** Complete audit trail of document movements - **Flexibility:**

Customizable for various document types and workflows - **Integration:** Seamless integration with Odoo's document management ecosystem

This module is ideal for organizations that need structured document management with physical-digital integration and strong organizational categorization capabilities.

Document Version: 1.0 **Last Updated:** February 6, 2026 **Status:** Production Ready